

Dell XPS 13 Plus

IO where?

The Dell XPS lineup of laptops has consistently been a top performer over the years, and the latest Dell XPS 13 Plus 9320 is certainly no slouch either. The unit we received came with a 12th gen Intel Core i7-1260P processor, 16GB of LPDDR5 RAM, 1 TB of NVMe SSD storage and a beautiful, 16:10, 4K touch-screen display. Powering the graphics you have Intel Iris Xe integrated graphics, and all of this comes in a compact package that weighs a little over 1.2 kg. The specs are certainly fantastic on paper, read on to find out how the Dell XPS 13 Plus fared during our benchmarking.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The new Dell XPS 13 Plus stays pretty much in line with the XPS lineup of laptops when it comes to aesthetics, but there are some immediately noticeable changes. Dell has done away with the chiclet style keyboard and instead uses a more traditional keyboard layout.

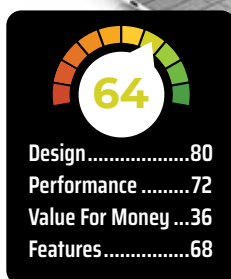
There's a capacitive touch bar that runs along the top of the keyboard. The entirety of the chassis' width is used for the keyboard, which allows for decently sized keys and an overall pleasant typing experience. Coming to the capacitive bar with the function keys, we were not big fans of the touch bar. We didn't see it serving any additional purposes other than being a gimmick and it behaved a bit finicky at times as well. Next we come to the touchpad, which seamlessly blends with the palm rest area of the Dell XPS 13 Plus and uses a single piece of glass. The XPS 13 Plus has a screen-to-body ratio of 89 percent thanks to its narrow bezels.

The overall build of the XPS 13 Plus is very robust, thanks to its primarily aluminium body, and we saw no flex whatsoever in both the base and lid.

IO PORTS, WEBCAM

There's been a bit of a trend with the XPS laptops over the years with each iteration shedding ports. The new XPS 13 Plus comes with only two Thunderbolt 4 USB-C ports; one on either side, and that's

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it. They've done away with the 3.5 mm stereo jack and card reader which was present in the previous XPS 13. The XPS 13 comes with a 720p webcam, which was a bit surprising; we were expecting a 1080p sensor. That said, the picture quality is decent in good lighting conditions.

DISPLAY

The XPS 13 Plus comes with a UHD+ 4K touch display with a refresh rate of 60Hz. The display comes with an advertised brightness of 500 nits, but we got closer to 400 peak average brightness during our testing. Coming to colour accuracy, the Dell XPS 13 Plus scored 99.9% in sRGB coverage, and 82.2% in DCI-P3 coverage. While these are good scores, this is not the best display we've tested within this segment. That said, it should work fine for your photo and video creator workloads.

PERFORMANCE

Since the XPS 13 Plus is very similarly specced to the Lenovo Yoga 9i, we'll be drawing comparisons between the two laptops. The XPS 13 Plus comes with a top-of-the-line 12th gen Intel Core i7-1260P processor, which falls only slightly short of the i7-1280P processor which is present in the Lenovo Yoga 9i. The benchmark results of PCMark 10, Cinebench R20, and R23 reflect

the same as well, but the XPS 13 Plus even manages to top Yoga 9 in some benchmarks. Either way, you will get great performance out of the XPS 13 Plus. Coming to memory, both the XPS 13 Plus and the Yoga 9i come with 16GB of LPDDR5 RAM clocked at 5200 MHz. The scores on AIDA64 show that they're extremely close for the most part, but the Yoga 9i does have a slight edge. When it comes to storage, again, both these laptops come with 1TB Samsung SSDs, however here the Dell XPS 13 Plus had the Yoga 9i beat in almost all aspects, so you're certainly getting a superfast SSD for your mobile creator needs. We did find that the Dell XPS 13 Plus throttles a lot more than the Yoga 9i, and the only solution would be to put the laptop on performance mode.

This was most evident during our synthetic GPU benchmarks, which we ran for the integrated graphics. Once again, both laptops feature Intel Iris Xe integrated graphics, but the Dell XPS 13 Plus fell slightly short. The scores still aren't bad, and the presence of two Thunderbolt 4 ports means that you can utilise an external GPU for graphically intensive workloads.

VERDICT

The hardware inside the XPS 13 Plus is top-of-the-line, including the display, and Dell has put in an effort to wring more performance out of the XPS 13 Plus, including a performance mode that makes the laptop fans faster (and louder), but this does impact overall battery life as well. We certainly felt the lack of IO port options, even though the two remaining ports are Thunderbolt 4 ports (which are quite versatile). Overall, the Dell XPS 13 Plus is still a beast of a machine but it felt a bit lacking in certain aspects.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: 12th Gen Intel Core i7-1260P, Intel Iris Xe Graphics | Display: 13.4-inch, UHD+ 60 Hz | RAM: 16 GB, LPDDR5 | Storage: 1 TB, M.2, Gen 4 PCIe NVMe SSD | Ports: 2 x Thunderbolt 4 | Weight: 1.26 kg | Battery: 3 Cell, 55 Wh

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